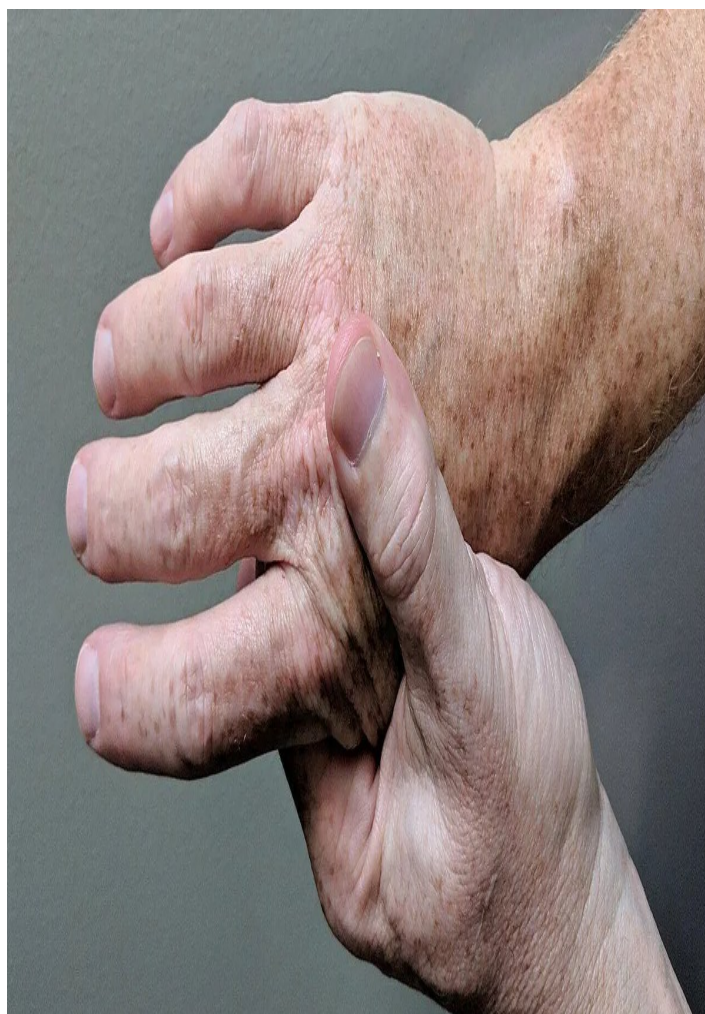


Best Gadgets and Daily Living Aids for Arthritis in the UK

From jar openers to ergonomic keyboards, these practical aids make daily life with arthritis easier, more comfortable, and more independent.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-03-08 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

Best Gadgets and Aids for Arthritis



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Arthritis can turn simple daily tasks — opening jars, buttoning shirts, typing — into painful challenges. Fortunately, a growing range of clever aids and gadgets can restore independence and reduce joint strain.

Kitchen Aids

****Jar and bottle openers:**** The Kuhn Rikon Swiss opener (£8–12) grips lids of any size. Electric jar openers remove the need for grip strength entirely.

****Ergonomic cutlery:**** Brands like Knork and Good Grips feature thick, cushioned handles that reduce the force needed to grip. Weighted cutlery can help with tremors too.



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****Kettle tippers:**** A cradle that tilts the kettle for you, avoiding the need to lift a heavy, boiling kettle. Available from disability retailers (£15–25).

****Tap turners:**** Lever-style attachments fit over standard taps, converting a twist into a push — much easier for arthritic hands.

****One-touch can openers:**** Electric can openers that require a single button press. The Hamilton Beach Smooth Touch (£20) is a popular choice.

Personal Care



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****Button hooks and zip pulls:**** Small tools that loop through buttonholes or zipper tabs, enabling dressing with minimal finger dexterity.

****Long-handled shoe horns:**** Avoid bending to put on shoes — essential for hip and knee arthritis.

****Electric toothbrushes:**** Require less grip and movement than manual brushing. The Oral-B iO Series is gentle on hands.

****Pump-style soap and shampoo:**** Eliminates the need to grip and squeeze bottles.

Technology

****Ergonomic keyboards:**** Split keyboards like the Microsoft Sculpt reduce wrist strain. Angled designs keep hands in a more natural position.

****Voice assistants:**** Amazon Echo and Google Home let you control lights, heating, timers, and shopping lists by voice — reducing the need for manual switches.

****Touchscreen styluses:**** A chunky stylus is easier to grip than tapping with painful fingers. The Meko Universal Stylus (£8) works on all smartphones and tablets.

****Dragon NaturallySpeaking:**** Voice recognition software that types as you speak — invaluable for those with hand arthritis who need to work at a computer.

Mobility Aids

****Walking stick ferrules:**** The Flexyfoot ferrule provides better grip and shock absorption than standard rubber tips.

****Reaching aids:**** Extend your reach without bending or stretching. Useful for high shelves, picking up dropped items, or garden tasks.

****Perching stools:**** Allow you to "sit" at kitchen worktop height while preparing food — reducing hip and knee load.

Where to Buy in the UK

- ****NRS Healthcare:**** Extensive range of daily living aids
- ****Ability Superstore:**** Online retailer specialising in disability aids
- ****Amazon:**** Wide range with user reviews
- ****Your local Occupational Therapy service:**** Can assess your needs and provide some aids free through the NHS. Ask your GP for a referral.

Financial Support

Some aids may be available free or subsidised: - ****NHS OT referral:**** Occupational therapists can prescribe certain aids on the NHS - ****Disabled Facilities Grant:**** Covers home adaptations up to £30,000 in England - ****VAT exemption:**** Many disability aids are VAT-free — look for "VAT relief" on product pages

Key Takeaway

The right gadgets and aids aren't about giving in to arthritis — they're about working smarter, protecting your joints, and maintaining your independence.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about best gadgets and daily living aids for arthritis in the uk?

Short answer: Many gadgets and daily living aids can help people with arthritis manage tasks and reduce joint strain. Examples include ergonomic jar openers, specially designed cutlery, and kettle tippers for the kitchen. Personal care aids like button hooks and long-handled shoe horns assist with dressing. Technology such as ergonomic keyboards, voice assistants, and styluses can also make daily life easier.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Arthritis UK: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis · livingwitharthritis.org.uk